

White Paper 06B — Authoring UX and Capture

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Plain definition

Authoring UX turns AGE's architecture into usable creative tools. It lets authors define worlds, systems, roles, events, overlays, and scripts without directly manipulating raw engine structures.

Problem addressed

AGE concepts are powerful but technical. Without good authoring tools, the system becomes inaccessible to creators.

Author types

Worldbuilder Authors define geography, cultures, factions, technology levels, history, locations, and world scaffolds.

System Authors define mechanics, rules references, resources, tests, conflict resolution, and CAL corpus policies.

Role Authors define NPCs, advisors, tutors, facilitators, and role contracts.

Adventure Authors define AGEScript packages, scenes, event tables, transitions, and consequence structures.

Capture loop

The author describes intent. The system proposes structured entities. The author reviews. The validator checks consistency. Preview simulation tests sample paths. The package records provenance and publishes.

Reward

AGE can scale content creation without forcing authors to become engine programmers.

Risk

If authoring hides too much, authors lose control. If it exposes too much, authors face schema burden.

Mitigation

Use layered UX: plain-language capture, structured editor, validation panel, simulation preview, and advanced schema access.

Success criteria

An author can build and publish a bounded adventure with locations, actors, events, rules references, and consequences that pass validation and run in the engine.